

Boat Purchase Analysis — 2026 Nautique G23

Independent market verification · August 16, 2026 · All prices re-checked against current listings

RECOMMENDATION: PROCEED AT \$329,100 — fair market price, and buying now beats waiting.

Condition: this only makes sense if the current boat's lack of power genuinely limits use. The upgrade costs roughly \$40–45K per year of ownership — the deal is fair, but it is not a bargain that pays for itself.

1. THE DEAL

Sticker (MSRP), loaded build: 630 hp supercharged engine, telescoping tower, full options	\$409,000
Negotiated price (includes triple-axle trailer)	\$329,100
Discount off sticker	19.5%

- **The \$409K sticker is legitimate.** An Idaho dealer lists a 2026 G23 with the same telescoping tower but the smaller 450 hp engine at \$378,781. The 630 hp upgrade runs ~\$30K, which lands right at \$409K.
- **19.5% off is the going rate, not a special deal.** Dealers are publicly advertising 16.7–17.3% off before any negotiation; owner forums report 15–20% as typical in today's soft market, 25% in some regions. This price is fair and well negotiated — nothing more.
- **Ignore the "25% effective discount" pitch.** That compares today's price to a guessed next-year sticker. No published evidence supports the claimed 7% increase (recent years ran 4–6%), and you could make the same "savings" next year against the higher sticker. The real number is 19.5%.
- **Dealer claims corrected:** the "bow thruster" is actually a stern-mounted steering assist and is an extra-cost option (it is on the build sheet, so it's included — but it isn't standard and isn't a bow thruster). The "larger surf tabs" are standard equipment on every G23 — not a concession.
- **Get freight/prep included in writing** — typically \$3–8K if excluded.

2. WHAT THE 2020 BOAT IS WORTH

Year	Asking price	Detail	Source
2020	\$149,900	450 hp, 124 hrs — Mooresville, NC	OnlyInboards
2020	\$149,995	450 hp, 61 hrs — Irvine, CA (sale pending)	YachtWorld
2020	\$149,995	Dealer retail — Montgomery, TX	Boatzon
2020	\$124,967	Jacksons Gap, AL (low end)	Boat Trader
2020	\$155,000	Bakersfield, CA (high end)	Boat Trader
2021	\$158,000 SOLD	263 hrs — actual sale, May 2025	OnlyInboards
2019	\$119,500–\$134,900	Three listings, TX / UT	Boatzon

- Boats are selling 5–12% below asking; time-on-market is up ~37% year over year. It is a buyer's market.
- A 2020 G23 owner reported an actual **\$112K dealer trade offer** (owner forum, documented thread).
- **Private sale: plan on ~\$130,000** (range \$125–138K). \$135–140K is possible only with low hours and patience.
- **Dealer trade-in: ~\$112,000** (range \$108–118K).

3. TAX AND NET COST TO SWITCH (IDAHO, 6%)

Idaho taxes only the difference when you trade in (confirmed, Idaho State Tax Commission); a private sale means tax on the full purchase price.

	Trade-in @ \$112,000	Private sale @ \$130,000
Purchase price	\$329,100	\$329,100
Taxable amount	\$217,100	\$329,100
Sales tax (6%)	\$13,026	\$19,746
Less proceeds from 2020	(\$112,000)	(\$130,000)
Net cost to switch	\$230,126	\$218,846

- The trade-in saves \$6,720 in tax, but selling private brings \$18,000 more — **private sale wins by ~\$11,300.**
- Simple rule: trade in only if a private sale would net less than **1.06 × the trade offer** ($\approx$ \$118,700 here).

4. BUY NOW VS. WAIT THREE YEARS (ALL FIGURES IN 2029 DOLLARS)

Path A (buy now): net outlay \$218,846, plus 3 years of foregone 5% investment return (\$34,496) = **\$253,342.**

Path B (wait): keep the 2020 (worth ~\$100K by 2029), then buy new at 2029 pricing with 6% tax on the full price.

Path B scenario	2029 sticker	Negotiated	Net outlay	Buying now saves
Best case: prices +5%/yr, 20% discounts persist	\$473,000	\$379,000	\$301,500	\$48,000
Central case: +6%/yr, 15% discount	\$487,000	\$414,000	\$339,000	\$86,000
Worst case: +7%/yr, discounts shrink to 10%	\$501,000	\$451,000	\$378,000	\$125,000

- **Buying now is cheaper in every scenario tested** — by \$48K to \$125K — and avoids three more years with the underpowered boat.
- Fine print: waiting does end with a 2029 boat instead of a 3-year-old 2026. The answer only approaches a tie if 20%+ discounts persist, price increases stay at 5%, invested cash earns ~10%, and the 2020 holds its value unusually well — all at once.

5. WHAT THE SWITCH REALLY COSTS (4-YEAR VIEW)

	Buy the 2026	Keep the 2020
Value today / basis	\$329,100	~\$130,000
Estimated value in 2030	\$185,000–\$205,000	\$95,000–\$105,000
4-year depreciation	\$125,000–\$145,000	\$25,000–\$35,000
Sales tax (sunk)	\$19,746	—
Foregone 5% return on cash outlay	~\$47,000	—
Extra cost of switching, 4 years	~\$165,000–\$180,000 ($\approx$ \$40–45K/yr)	

That is the honest price of running a new 630 hp boat under warranty instead of the 2020. The discount doesn't change it — the justification is use and enjoyment, not economics.

6. RESALE NOTES

- The 2025 full redesign of the G-Series is compressing values of all older-body G23s (the 2020 included) — roughly 130 leftover new old-body boats are being cleared at discounts. **This argues for selling the 2020 sooner, not later.** The 2026 being purchased is the new body style, which helps its future resale.
- Worth one phone call: loaded G23 **Paragons** (the higher trim) with the same 630 hp engine are advertised at \$365,000–\$389,000. For \$30–50K more it may be the stronger long-term hold.

Sources: current listings on Boat Trader, OnlyInboards, YachtWorld, Boatzon and dealer sites; Idaho State Tax Commission (tax rules); PlanetNautique owner forums (actual trade offers and discount reports). Listing prices are asking prices unless marked SOLD. Full source URLs are in the companion detailed report (boat-deal-verification.md).